

Modified FOLFOX-6

Oxaliplatin + folinic acid + 5-fluorouracil (5-FU)

WHAT THIS REGIMEN IS FOR

A 14-day chemotherapy regimen used across several gastrointestinal cancer treatment plans. Your oncology team should confirm your treatment purpose and planned number of cycles.

MEDICINES

Oxaliplatin

Folinic acid

5-fluorouracil (5-FU)

TREATMENT JOURNEY

Day 1 Oxaliplatin and folinic acid are given by drip, then 5-FU is started.	Days 1-3 A portable pump gives 5-FU continuously for about 46 hours.	Around day 3 Pump disconnect. Follow your local line and pump instructions.	Days 4-14 Recovery and monitoring. Symptoms can occur on any day.	Day 15 Next cycle if review and blood tests allow.
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REGIMEN-SPECIFIC POINT
Cold sensitivity after oxaliplatin is distinctive. Avoid cold drinks, freezer items and cold air when these trigger symptoms.

MONITORING / SUPPORT

- DPD status is checked before fluoropyrimidine treatment.
- Before each cycle: blood count, kidney/liver bloods and assessment of nerve symptoms.
- Follow your own labelled anti-sickness, mouth-care and diarrhoea medicines.

Where changes may show up

Patient-first anatomical guide · report the symptom rather than trying to diagnose the cause

Mouth + throat

Mouth soreness or ulcers can make eating difficult. Sudden throat tightness, especially around cold exposure, needs prompt assessment.

Heart + breathing

New chest pain, pressure, fainting or breathlessness needs urgent help. Rare 5-FU heart effects can start during infusion.

Bowel + stomach

Nausea, vomiting or diarrhoea can occur. Persistent diarrhoea or dehydration needs advice.

Blood + infection

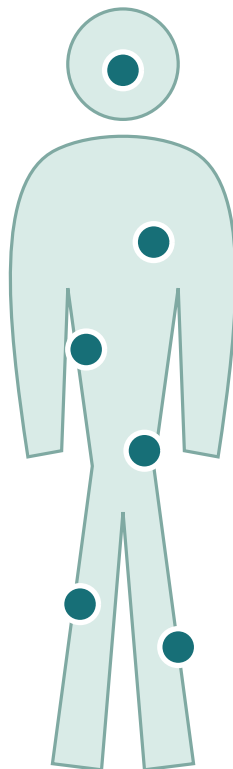
White cells can fall later in a cycle. Fever, shivers or suddenly feeling unwell needs immediate oncology contact.

Hands, feet + nerves

Cold-triggered tingling may start early; numbness can build over cycles. Report persistent symptoms before the next dose.

Line + pump

Pain, redness, swelling, leakage, disconnection or a pump alarm should be reported immediately.



WHEN TO CALL

Call your oncology SOS service for fever or shivers, sudden illness, 4 or more diarrhoea episodes in a day, vomiting despite medicines, mouth sores stopping fluids, bleeding, new chest pain or breathlessness. Severe chest pain or breathing difficulty: call 112/999.



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